France, Germany strike bargain on Made in Europe, car emissions

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【要点】

・フランスとドイツが、EU産自動車の地域内調達要件を厳しくする代わりに、2035年の車両排出削減目標を100%から90%に緩和することで合意した。

・この合意により、EUの産業競争力と技術的自主性を強化しながら気候目標を追求する「バランスの取れたアプローチ」が実現するとしている。

・フランコ独協定の下で、一定条件下でイギリスとスイスもMade in Europe対象に含められることが明確にされた。

・ドイツの連立政権内の反対意見が解決され、ドイツ社会民主党が反対を撤回したことで合意が成立した。

・ドイツは新しい機会を活用して投資と雇用を国内に確保することが期待されている。

【メール原文】

BRUSSELS — France and Germany said Friday they had struck a deal to favor European-made cars under a landmark EU industry bill in exchange for weakeni
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France, Germany strike bargain on Made in Europe, car emissions
By Giorgio Leali, Hans von der Burchard, Jordyn Dahl · Oct 16, 2026, 1:04 PM · View in your browser

BRUSSELS — France and Germany said Friday they had struck a deal to favor European-made cars under a landmark EU industry bill in exchange for weakening a 2035 vehicle emissions target, ending months of wrangling between the bloc's two biggest economies.

Under the agreement, Germany would accept stricter "Made in Europe" — or local content — requirements for the automotive industry in the proposed Industrial Accelerator Act, a longstanding French demand, while France would back Berlin's push to relax the EU's plan to phase out new combustion-engine cars.

The EU's current target is for companies to reduce emissions from new vehicles by 100% from 2021 levels by 2035, with the possibility to "earn" 10% of emissions leeway through initiatives like offsets and investments.

France and Germany now want to soften the 2035 target to 90%, and to offer a further 10% leeway in exchange for investments in alternative fuels — effectively reducing the emissions-cutting requirement to 80%.

"This balanced approach will enable the European Union to pursue its climate objectives while strengthening the technological sovereignty, industrial base and international competitiveness of its automotive industry," the two countries said in a joint statement .

The agreement, first reported by POLITICO in July , was due to have been announced Thursday, during a meeting of EU leaders in Brussels. But it was held up at the last minute by disagreements within Germany's governing coalition.

"We hope that this Franco-German dynamic can swiftly lead to an agreement with our partners, for our jobs and our industry," French President Emmanuel Macron said in a post on social media.

An Elysée official on Friday made clear that, under the Franco-German deal, the scope of Made in Europe for automotive can be extended to the U.K. and Switzerland under certain conditions. — addressing a key concern of Prime Minister Andy Burnham's government ahead of a Nov. 20 U.K.-EU summit in Brussels.

The agreement was reached after the German Social Democratic Party, the junior partner in Chancellor Friedrich Merz's coalition government, dropped its opposition.

"This is a modern realignment of German industrial policy that places significantly greater emphasis on preserving jobs and production sites," said German Environment Minister Carsten Schneider, who is from the SPD.

"The clear expectation for German companies is that they will use these new opportunities to make investments and guarantee jobs here in Germany," he added.

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